

Introduction to Systematic Reviews

Systematic reviews synthesize evidence from multiple primary studies. They provide a comprehensive, unbiased summary of the existing research on a defined topic using explicit and reproducible methods. This makes them the highest level of evidence in the hierarchy of study designs.

Methods and Data Extraction

Data extraction involves collecting relevant information from each included study using a pre-specified extraction form. Two independent reviewers extract the data and any discrepancies are resolved through discussion or by consulting a third reviewer when consensus cannot be reached.